Loaded Baked Potato Soup

Soups | Instant Pot

Before you start

Peel and cut potatoes into 1-inch chunks; chop bacon; dice onion; mince garlic; soften and chunk cream cheese; shred cheddar; slice green onions. Pressure cook 8 minutes on High, then quick release.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Potatoes, broth, salt, pepper, and garlic powder

- [ ] 3.5 lb russet potatoes, peeled and cut into 1-inch chunks (that's like 8 potatoes) [Bowl A]

- [ ] 8 slices bacon, chopped (1/2 pound. Maybe just cook a whole pound)
- [ ] 1 medium onion, diced
- [ ] 4 cloves garlic, minced
- [ ] 4 1/2 cups chicken broth [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 1/4 tsp salt, plus more to taste [Bowl A]
- [ ] 3/4 tsp black pepper [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp garlic powder [Bowl A]
- [ ] 4 oz cream cheese, softened and cut into chunks
- [ ] 1 cup heavy cream
- [ ] 1 1/2 cups sharp cheddar cheese, shredded
- [ ] 1/2 cup sour cream
- [ ] 3-4 green onions, sliced
- [ ] For serving: extra cheddar, bacon, sour cream, and green onions.

1. Prepare and cook

1. Set the Instant Pot to Sauté. Add the chopped bacon and cook until crisp. Remove the bacon with a slotted spoon and set aside. Leave about 2 tablespoons bacon fat in the pot.

2. Add the onion and sauté for about 3-4 minutes, until softened. Add the garlic and cook for another 30 seconds.

3. Pour in a splash of the chicken broth and scrape the bottom of the pot thoroughly to loosen any browned bits.

4. Add the potatoes, remaining chicken broth, salt, pepper, and garlic powder.

5. Seal the Instant Pot and cook on High Pressure for 8 minutes. When finished, carefully perform a quick release.

6. Open the pot and use a potato masher to mash roughly half of the potatoes, leaving plenty of chunks.

7. Turn the Instant Pot back to Sauté on Low. Add the cream cheese and stir until it is completely melted into the soup.

8. Stir in the 1 cup heavy cream. Let the soup warm gently for a couple of minutes, but don't let it boil aggressively.

9. Press Cancel to turn off the heat. Stir in the shredded cheddar until melted, then stir in the sour cream.

10. Stir in about two-thirds of the cooked bacon and most of the green onions. Taste and add additional salt and pepper if needed.

11. Let the soup sit for 5-10 minutes before serving. It will continue to thicken as it stands.

12. Top each bowl with the reserved bacon, cheddar, green onions, and a spoonful of sour cream.